

[Request] How much water is used per AI prompt/message?

Posted by u/jilliancaprice • 0 points • 9 comments

Apologies if this has already been answered!

Comments

u/TheJeeronian • 2 points • 2025-11-21 02:40 UTC

I've done this for different reasons in several different threads, so apologies for the lack of math but I'm not stoked to repeat previous answers.

The answer varies a lot depending on the model, prompt, and assumptions that we choose to make. A charitable approach gave me 3ml, if memory serves, and a less charitable approach was closer to 500ml.

What none of this includes is the training process, which is very intensive but only has to be done initially. As such, the more a particular model is used after it is made, the smaller this becomes approaching 0.

u/[deleted] • 1 points • 2025-11-21 02:32 UTC

[removed]

u/MiyaBera • -5 points • 2025-11-20 23:36 UTC

I have no idea what you mean by this question. Do you think the AI drinks it? If you mean how much water is used to cool the servers then the answer changes depending on which server, what model, which company, and the length of the prompt

u/jilliancaprice • 3 points • 2025-11-20 23:39 UTC

Lmfao I didn't know how to phrase my question! I guess I'm wondering the average

u/cipheron • 0 points • 2025-11-20 23:48 UTC

You can run a model on your home computer such as deepseek. That uses no water.

u/OcelotInTheWntr • 1 points • 2025-11-21 01:31 UTC

Even if you run it on your home computer, it's pulling data and computing power from the main servers not your computer, home computers simply don't have the processing power to run ai stuff like that

u/cipheron • 1 points • 2025-11-21 01:42 UTC

I'm talking about locally hosted models that you run on your GPU.

u/Weisenkrone • 1 points • 2025-11-21 08:35 UTC

When people talk about water consumption of digital infrastructure, this extends a little further beyond the literal meaning ... I assumed this was common knowledge, but apparently not.

It's talking about the water consumption of the powerplant and about the large cooling systems which practically distill water which causes a bunch of issues on its own too.

If you run a home system, you still have to account for your local electric grid. Even if you lean into the renewable energy option you have to account for the water consumption in the manufacturing of the said renewable energy option.

Data centers don't just randomly delete water to run.

To some extent you could argue your home system doesn't consume water for cooling, but that's wrong too. You vent the heat and let the environment absorb it.

u/AutoModerator • 1 points • 2025-11-20 23:20 UTC

###General Discussion Thread

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